Social Science I
Chapter-6
Mass Movement for Freedom

1.What are the changes brought about by the leadership of Mahatma Gandhi in the freedom movement of India?

- After Mahatma Gandhi had become the leader of the freedom movement, various sections of society, including peasants, workers, women, and students actively participated in the struggles.
- He was able to unite everyone under a single umbrella and could become one of them.

2.Identify the features of the early movements in which Gandhiji participated in India. ?

Gandhiji's Early Struggles (1917–1918):

1.Champaran Movement (1917)

- In 1917, Gandhiji intervened in the problems faced by indigo cultivators in Champaran, Bihar.
- The European planters were exploiting the indigo cultivators.
- As a result of Gandhiji's intervention, the British administration appointed a commission to investigate the grievances.
- Consequently, the issues of the peasants were largely resolved.

2.Ahmedabad Mill Strike (1918)

- In 1918, Gandhiji participated in the struggle of textile mill workers in Ahmedabad, Gujarat.
- They demanded a wage hike.
- Gandhiji went on a fast to support them.
- Subsequently the workers' wages were increased.

3.Kheda Satyagraha (1918)

- In 1918, Gandhiji fought for the peasants of Kheda in Gujarat.
- The cultivators of Kheda were unable to pay tax due to natural calamities.
- They demanded tax remission.
- Gandhiji toured the villages and encouraged them.
- The government agreed to grant tax remission to the cultivators

3.What were the economic impacts of the First World War on India?"

- Additional wartime taxes were levied on the people.
- Huge quantities of food grains were exported for soldiers
- Severe food shortage.
- Crop losses and epidemics
- Many people died of famine.

4.What were the main provisions of the Rowlatt Act of 1919?

- Anyone could be arrested without a warrant.
- Anyone could be jailed without trial.

5.Write a short note on the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre.

- The anti-Rowlatt agitation in Punjab led to the arrest of Dr. Satyapal and Dr. Saifuddin Kitchlew.
- Martial law was declared in Amritsar.
- On April 13, 1919, people gathered at Jallianwala Bagh in Amritsar to protest against the arrest of their leaders.
- General Dyer ordered the British police to fire on the crowd without warning.
- The ground had only one entrance.
- According to official records, 379 people were killed and over a thousand were injured.

6.The Khilafat Movement

- The Khilafat Movement began with the objective of restoring the powers of the Caliph.
- Gandhiji understood that Hindu-Muslim unity was essential for national solidarity.
- To achieve this unity, Gandhiji took up the Khilafat issue.
- The Khilafat Movement in India was led by Muhammad Ali and Shaukat Ali.

7.What were the methods adopted in the Non-Cooperation Movement?

- Returning titles of honours granted by the British government
- Resigning from government jobs
- Advocates boycotting British courts
- Students boycotting British-run schools
- Boycotting foreign goods
- Boycotting legislative assemblies

8.What were the key programmes implemented during the Non-Cooperation Movement?

- Strengthening social harmony
- Promoting the use of national products
- Popularising khadi
- Establishing national schools

9.How did various sections of society participate in the Non-Cooperation Movement?

Woman:Women participated in the movement by boycotting foreign goods, and collecting and burning foreign clothes.

Workers:Workers actively took part in the Non-Cooperation Movement. Workers of Mills in Madras, the Assam-Bengal Railway, and plantation labourers in Assam went on strike.

Students: Thousands of students boycotted government schools and colleges.

- They enrolled in national institutions to continue their studies.
- The Kashi Vidyapeeth in Banaras, Gujarat Vidyapeeth, and Jamia Millia Islamia in Aligarh were the national institutions founded during this time.

Tribal People:The tribal communities participated in the movement by defying British-imposed forest laws.

Peasants: Peasants participated in the movement in large numbers.

- The 'Awadh Kisan Sabha' was formed under the leadership of Jawaharlal Nehru
- In Bengal, peasants boycotted jute cultivation and grow rice and cotton.

10.What were the main objectives behind the decision to grow rice and cotton instead of jute?

- To force British owners to close down their jute mills by curtailing the supply of jute
- To ensure food security by expanding rice cultivation
- To increase the use of khadi and generate khadi related job opportunities by making cotton available

11.Prepare a short note on the Chauri Chaura incident?

- On February 5, 1922, during the Non-Cooperation Movement, violence broke out at Chauri Chaura in Uttar Pradesh.
- An enraged mob set the police station on fire, killing 22 policemen.
- Gandhiji stopped the movement as it violated non-violence.
- Subhas Chandra Bose called it a "national calamity."

12.How did the policies of the Swaraj Party differ from those of the Non-Cooperation Movement?

- The Non-Cooperation Movement boycotted elections and legislative assemblies.
- The Swaraj Party formed in 1923 by C. R. Das and Motilal Nehru opposed this strategy.
- They used the assemblies to voice political dissent.
- They participated in elections,became members of legislative assemblies, and criticised the government.

13.What were the main features of the Rampa Rebellion?

- The Rampa Rebellion was a tribal movement in Andhra Pradesh.It was led by Alluri Sitarama Raju.
- The rebellion arose due to British forest laws that restricted the tribals' rights to graze cattle and use forest resources.
- Moneylenders also exploited the tribal people.
- The British suppressed the revolt using military forces, including the Malabar Special Police and the Assam Rifles.
- Alluri Sitarama Raju was killed during the agitation.

14.Write a short note on the Anti-Simon Commission movement.

- The Simon Commission was led by Sir John Simon to suggest reforms for India.
- All members were British, so Congress and others boycotted it.
- A hartal was held on February 3, 1928, with slogans “Simon Go Back.”
- Lala Lajpat Rai was injured in Lahore and later died.
- The Nehru Committee, led by Motilal Nehru, prepared the Nehru Report, shaping India’s Constitution.

15.What were the main features of the Bardoli Peasants Movement?

- The Bardoli Peasants Movement took place in 1928 in Gujarat.
- It was led by Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
- The agitation began due to the increase in tax, and peasants refused to pay it.
- The government seized their lands and property.
- Gandhiji supported the peasants, and the government finally withdrew the tax.

16.What made the Lahore Congress a milestone in India’s freedom struggle?

• The Congress demanded complete independence for the first time.

• It entrusted Gandhiji with the responsibility to launch a mass movement to achieve this goal.

• The tricolour flag was formally adopted.

17.Describe how Gandhiji initiated the Civil Disobedience Movement.

- To ensure participation from all sections of society,Gandhiji decided to begin the movement by breaking the salt law.
- He marched to Dandi Beach in Gujarat with 78 selected volunteers.
- The march lasted for 24 days
- Gandhiji advised people to maintain cleanliness, wear khadi, and promote social harmony.
- On April 6, 1930, Gandhiji broke the salt law by making salt on Dandi beach.

18.Who led the Civil Disobedience Movement in Northwestern India and what was his contribution?

- Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan led the movement in Northwestern India.
- He was known as the ‘Frontier Gandhi.’
- He organized a volunteer force called the Khudai Khidmatgar.
- His leadership inspired many to join the movement in that region.

19.How various sections of society participated in the Civil Disobedience movement.

- Peasants -Refused to pay land tax and rent.
- Workers -Labourers in railways, ports, and mines participated in the movement.
- Tribal People -Collected forest produce, defying forest laws.
- Women -Took part in salt making and picketing foreign goods.
- Traders/Industrialists--They refused to buy or sell imported products..

20.Write a short note on the Round Table Conferences.?

- The Round Table Conferences were held in London to discuss the transfer of power to Indians.
- The Congress boycotted the First Round Table Conference in 1930.
- Gandhiji attended the Second Round Table Conference as part of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact.
- The Second Conference ended without success, and the Congress boycotted the Third Round Table Conference.

21.What were the main provisions of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact signed on March 5, 1931?

- The Civil Disobedience Movement was suspended.
- Gandhiji participated in the Second Round Table Conference.

22.Write a short note on the major revolutionary activities led by Bhagat Singh?

- The Hindustan Republican Association (HRA) was formed in 1924.
- In 1928, Bhagat Singh founded the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA).
- Saunders, who took part in the lathicharge that led to Lala Lajpat Rai’s death, was shot dead by the revolutionaries.

- A bomb was thrown into the Central Legislative Assembly Hall.
- Bhagat Singh, Rajguru, and Sukhdev were arrested and executed on March 23, 1931.
- Women like Pritilata Waddedar, Kalpana Dutt, and Bina Das also participated.

23.What were the aims and activities of the Congress Socialist Party?

- The Congress Socialist Party (CSP) was formed by Congress members with socialist ideas.
- Jayaprakash Narayan was its first Secretary.
- The party aimed to build a socialist society and counter capitalism and landlordism.
- It organised workers and peasants and addressed their issues.

24.Describe the major peasant movements and their significance in India's freedom struggle.

- Farmers faced hardships such as excessive taxation, exploitation by landlords, and eviction.
- They formed "kisan sabhas," and the Eka Movement in Awadh.
- The formation of the All India Kisan Sabha in 1936 marked a significant milestone in the peasant movement.
- In the 1940s, the Tebhaga Movement in Bengal and the Telangana Movement in Andhra played a key role in the freedom struggle.

25.Describe the major issues faced by labourers and the important labour movements in India.

- Labourers faced low wages, long working hours, and exploitation of women and children.
- The All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC) was the first national labour organisation.
- Strikes by railway, telegraph workers and Bombay labourers supporting the Royal Indian Navy Mutiny caused unrest and violence.

26.Describe the main events and features of the Quit India Movement.

- The Quit India Movement began on 8th August 1942, with Gandhiji's call of "Do or Die."
- It spread across the country even though Gandhiji and other leaders were imprisoned.
- Students, youth, workers, and women all took up the struggle.
- Post offices, telegraph offices, and railway stations were targeted.
- Leaders like Jayaprakash Narayan, Ram Manohar Lohia, Aruna Asaf Ali, and Sucheta Kripalani led the struggle from hiding.
- They communicated through the secret Congress Radio from Bombay.
- The movement turned violent in some areas.
- Gandhiji observed a 21-day fast in jail .
- Some areas were liberated, and temporary governments were established.

27.Name the regions where parallel governments were formed during the Quit India Movement and describe their activities.

- In Satara, Maharashtra, a parallel government under Nana Patil lasted until 1945.
- In Ballia, Uttar Pradesh, a parallel government was led by Chittu Pandey.
- In Tamluk, Bengal, the government lasted for a year and worked effectively by funding schools, establishing courts, and distributing surplus grain to the poor.

28.Describe the role of Subhas Chandra Bose in India's freedom struggle.

- Subhas Chandra Bose was a leader who took a different path for India's freedom.
- He served twice as the President of the Congress.
- Due to differences with Gandhiji, he resigned from the Congress and formed the Forward Bloc party.
- During World War II, he reached Singapore and took up the leadership of the Indian National Army.
- He reorganised the INA and marched to India with the Japanese army.

29.When did the Cabinet Mission come to India, and what was its purpose?

- The Cabinet Mission arrived in India in March 1946 to discuss the transfer of power.
- Its members were Stafford Cripps, Pethick Lawrence, and A. V. Alexander.

The key proposals included:

- Formation of an interim government until the transfer of power.
- Establishment of a Constituent Assembly to draft a constitution for India.

30. What were the main features of the Mountbatten Plan?

- The Mountbatten Plan was proposed by Lord Mountbatten, the last Viceroy of India, on June 3, 1947.
- It proposed the partition of the country into India and Pakistan.
- It also suggested granting independence to both nations.